

CADENCE

Theatre & Nursing Rota, On-Call, and Staff Scheduling

User Guide

University Hospitals Plymouth NHS Trust
Cardiothoracic Theatres

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1. Introduction

What is Cadence?

Cadence is the department's own theatre rota system — built specifically for how Cardiac Theatres actually works, rather than adapted from a generic scheduling tool. It replaces the previous spreadsheet-and-printout approach with a single, always-up-to-date system that everyone in the department can check from a phone, tablet, or computer.

It now covers two parallel rotas — the SODP/anaesthetist rota and the nursing rota — plus a live Theatre Board, on-call calendars for both teams, individual staff statistics, and department-wide administration, all built around the same underlying data so nothing has to be entered twice.

Who it's for

- Everyone in the department can view both rotas, both on-call calendars, the Theatre Board, and Staff Profiles from any device.
- Editors (typically senior SODPs, nurse coordinators, or team leads) can additionally build and publish their team's weekly rota.
- Admins can additionally manage theatres, staff, user accounts, and department-wide settings.
- A fourth account type, Board, exists purely for a shared kiosk screen — see Section 3 and Section 14.

Section 14 has a full breakdown of what each account type can and can't do.

Key benefits

- One source of truth. Everyone sees the same live rota — no separate copies to keep in sync, and no risk of someone working from an outdated printout.
- Available anywhere. Works on a phone, iPad, or desktop, and can be installed like a normal app on a phone or tablet home screen.
- Works with no signal. Once you've opened the app, it keeps working with poor or no wifi — useful in theatre corridors and changing rooms. Any changes made offline sync automatically once signal returns.
- Built-in accountability. Every rota change is logged automatically — who changed what, and when — visible to admins under Administration.
- Reduces errors. The system won't let the same person be double-booked across two theatres on the same day, and on-call cover is always visible at a glance.
- Learns from your own history. Theatre Intelligence and Staff Profiles surface genuine patterns from your published rotas — busiest theatres, on-call workload, regular pairings — with no manual reporting required.
- Covers the whole department. The SODP/anaesthetist rota and the nursing rota (nurses, HCAs, coordinators, and surgeons) run side by side as full, independent modules, sharing only the theatre list and list-type options.

2. Getting Started

Signing in

Go to the Cadence web address given to you by your admin. Enter the email address and password you were given, and select Sign in. You'll land on the Theatre Board — see Section 3 — which is now everyone's home screen.

The first time you're given an account, you'll be given a temporary password by your admin directly. It's worth changing this to something memorable once you're in — see Section 11.

Forgot your password?

On the sign-in screen, select Forgot password? and enter your email address. You'll be sent a link to set a new password. For security, you'll see the same confirmation message whether or not that email has an account — this is normal and not an error.

Account types at a glance

Account	View rota, calendars, profiles	Edit & publish a rota	Manage theatres, staff, accounts
Viewer	Yes	No	No
Editor	Yes	Yes (their team's rota)	No
Admin	Yes	Yes	Yes
Board	Theatre Board only	No	No

Your account type is set by your admin when your account is created, and can be changed at any time under Administration → User accounts.

3. Theatre Board

The Theatre Board is the shared, live status screen — everyone's landing page after signing in, and designed to also run permanently on a corridor TV or kiosk logged in as a Board account. It updates automatically and needs no interaction to stay current.

What it shows

- The coordinator for the day, front and centre in the header.
- Every theatre as its own card — status dot, list type, SODP(s), anaesthetist, surgeon, and the nursing team allocated.
- Support staff and on-call cover for both teams (SODP/anaesthetist and nursing) side by side.
- A Team Board anyone can post a short update to — shared department-wide and separate from the Team Boards on the two dashboards (Section 4 and 6).
- A small "Today in Cardiothoracic History" fact, and a QR code for signing in on your own phone — both covered below.

Day, night, and weekend views

The board switches automatically between three layouts depending on the time of day, so it always shows what's actually relevant:

- Daytime (weekdays, roughly 06:30–19:00) — the full theatre grid, coordinator, and support staff.
- Night (weekday evenings/overnight) — on-call cover only, shown larger since it's the only thing left to check.
- Weekend (Saturday and Sunday) — the weekend waiting list and on-call cover, with "No list this weekend" shown honestly when nothing's been added rather than a confusing blank.

A small heartbeat-trace LIVE badge next to the hospital name confirms the board is live and updating.

Today in Cardiothoracic History

A small card above the theatre grid marks genuine anniversaries from the history of cardiac and thoracic surgery — a first operation, a pioneering device, a landmark case — each with a real source behind it. On a day without a specific dated anniversary, it shows an undated "spotlight" fact instead (a pioneer, an instrument, a procedure) clearly labelled as such, rather than implying something happened that day that didn't. On a day with nothing in either pool yet, the card simply doesn't appear. It's still a growing collection rather than a complete year, and expands over time.

Scan to view

A QR code next to the Team Board lets anyone sign in on their own phone with no typing — useful for staff using a shared department login rather than an individual account. Scanning it opens Cadence and signs straight in to the Theatre Board.

Posting to the Team Board on a shared login

Since a shared Viewer or Board login looks the same for everyone using it, posting a message for the first time on a given device asks for a first name — remembered on that device from then on, the same "remembered on this device" pattern My Week uses (Section 4) — so posts stay attributable to a person

rather than all showing the same generic account name. Select Not you? to clear it and enter a different name. Editor and Admin accounts, which already have their own individual login, are never asked.

4. SODP Dashboard

The SODP Dashboard is the day-by-day home screen for the SODP/anaesthetist rota.

Live theatre status

Each theatre appears as its own card, showing a status dot (available, a list running, or closed), the list type if one has been set, and the SODP(s) and anaesthetist allocated for that day.

Week and day navigation

Use Previous week / Next week to move between weeks, and This week to jump straight back to today. The row of day tabs lets you flip through any day of the selected week — today's tab is always outlined even when you're looking at a different day, and moving between weeks keeps you on the same day of the week rather than resetting to Monday.

If a bank holiday has been set up in Administration, it's flagged automatically at the top of the page on the relevant day.

Sessions and on-call summary

Summary cards show the number of theatres running that day, Support SODP, who's on call as SODP (with a FROM HOME badge if that's been marked), and who's on call as anaesthetist. Weekends show the waiting list SODP and anaesthetist instead.

Theatre Intelligence

A rotating set of genuine facts pulled from the department's own published rota history — total sessions run, the busiest theatre, the busiest and quietest day of the week, utilisation, week-over-week trends, who's covered the most on-call or Support shifts, and the most frequent SODP/anaesthetist pairing. Select Shuffle to see a different set. Facts only ever appear once there's enough real history behind them — it won't state something as a pattern from a single data point.

Team Board

A shared, informal message board for the SODP team — anyone can post a short update, and it resets each day with everything moved into a browsable Archive. Entirely separate from the Theatre Board's and the Nursing Dashboard's boards.

My Week

Select your name once from the list and Cadence remembers it on that device. From then on, My Week shows your placements across all seven days of whichever week you're viewing — which theatre, on-call, Support, or "Not rostered" for each day. Select Not you? Switch name to change it.

5. SODP Rota

This is where the weekly SODP/anaesthetist rota is built. Viewers see it read-only; Editors and Admins can make changes.

Editing a week

Use the date picker to choose which week you're working on — it always opens on the current week by default. Each theatre has slots for up to two SODPs, an anaesthetist, and a list type. Support and on-call are set separately per day.

Note: Selecting someone as a SODP or anaesthetist in one theatre automatically removes them from the dropdown in every other theatre for that day — it isn't possible to accidentally double-book someone across two theatres. On-call dropdowns always show everyone, regardless of who's already allocated elsewhere that day.

List types

Each theatre and the Support slot has a list-type field — ROUTINE, EMERGENCY, and URGENT are included by default, and an admin can add department-specific values (e.g. NO LIST, THORACIC, CARDIAC) under Administration → List types. A theatre given a list type but no staff (a custom list running elsewhere, or one you haven't staffed yet) shows that list type clearly rather than looking simply unstaffed.

On-call

Weekdays show a single on-call SODP and anaesthetist, plus a From home tickbox for when on-call is being covered remotely. Weekends show two SODP slots each with a session (ALL DAY / AM / PM), an on-call anaesthetist, and a weekend waiting-list SODP and anaesthetist.

Clearing and saving

- Clear week wipes every box for the week currently on screen (with a confirmation prompt) — useful for starting a week from scratch.
- Save draft saves your progress without making it visible on the Dashboard, Calendar, Theatre Board, or Staff Profiles.
- Publish makes the week live everywhere — this is also what feeds Theatre Intelligence and Staff Profiles, so a week needs to be published (not just saved as a draft) to count toward those statistics.

Full week view

Shows the whole week — weekday and weekend — in a clean, read-only layout with the hospital and department name at the top. Useful for a quick visual check before publishing. Select Back to editing to return to normal.

Print preview

Prints the current week as a bordered, black-and-white-friendly grid formatted for A4 landscape — the whole week fits on a single page, with the hospital name, department name, and week-commencing date at the top, ready to put up in the department. A FROM HOME badge appears directly under the

on-call SODP when that's been marked.

6. Nursing Dashboard

The nursing team's equivalent of the SODP Dashboard — same layout and behaviour, built around the nursing rota's own data.

Live theatre status

Each theatre card shows its status, list type, the nursing team (nurses and HCAs), and the surgeon allocated for that day.

Coordinator and on-call

The day's coordinator is shown prominently. On-call summary cards cover the on-call nurses, HCA, and both the cardiac and thoracic on-call surgeons — the nursing rota tracks these separately since cardiac and thoracic cover don't always fall to the same person. Weekends show the same waiting-list breakdown, with "No list this weekend" shown when nothing's been added.

Theatre Intelligence and Team Board

The same kind of rotating, genuine facts as the SODP Dashboard — busiest theatre and day, utilisation, on-call and Support workload, coordinator frequency — built entirely from the nursing rota's own published history. The nursing Team Board is separate from the SODP Dashboard's and the Theatre Board's.

7. Nursing Rota

Same editing pattern as the SODP Rota, built around the nursing team's own fields: up to four nurses and two HCAs per theatre, one surgeon, a list type, a Coordinator (picked freely from any nurse, not restricted by other placements that day), and support/on-call cover for nurses, HCAs, and both cardiac and thoracic on-call surgeons.

Mutual exclusion works the same way as the SODP rota: a nurse or HCA picked in one theatre (or the Support column) is automatically hidden from every other theatre that day, so nobody gets double-booked. On-call and the weekend waiting list are never restricted, since they're a separate commitment rather than a same-day placement.

Print preview

Because the nursing rota has one more column than the SODP rota (the Coordinator), the printed grid is split across two A4 landscape pages instead of one: the weekday grid (Monday–Friday) on the first page, and the weekend grid on the second, so neither page feels cramped.

8. On Call Calendars

Both teams have their own month-at-a-glance on-call calendar — the SODP On Call Calendar and the Nursing On Call Calendar — showing who's covering, for every day of the month, without having to open each week individually.

- Bank holidays are marked with a coloured outline and a small dot.
- Today is highlighted.
- Selecting any day jumps straight to that day on the matching dashboard.
- Use Previous month / Next month to browse, and This month to jump back to today's month.

9. Staff Profiles

Look up anyone in the department — SODPs, anaesthetists, nurses (by band), AP/TAPs, HCAs, or surgeons — to see their history, built entirely from published rota data. SODPs and anaesthetists pull from the SODP rota; everyone else pulls from the nursing rota.

- Total theatre sessions worked, on-call count, and Support duty count (Coordinated count too, for nursing staff who coordinate).
- Their favourite (most-worked) theatre.
- A work-pattern breakdown by day of the week.
- Their most frequent colleague — for a SODP, the anaesthetist they've worked with most (and vice versa); for nursing staff, the surgeon they've worked with most (and vice versa).
- Badges for notable milestones — Regular (20+ sessions), On-call veteran (10+ shifts), Coordination veteran (10+ shifts, nursing only), Team player (worked with 5+ colleagues), and a "[Theatre] regular" badge where one theatre clearly dominates.

As with Theatre Intelligence, this only ever reflects published weeks, and is honest about showing "no history yet" rather than guessing.

10. Administration

Visible only to Admins. This is where the department itself is configured.

Department details

The hospital/Trust name and department name shown throughout the app, on the Theatre Board, and on both printed rotas.

Theatres

Add or remove theatres — shared by both rotas. Removing a theatre doesn't delete any past rota data already recorded against it.

Staff

The people who can be allocated on either rota, added under seven separate boxes: SODPs, Anaesthetists, Band 5 Nurses, Band 6 Nurses, Band 4 AP/TAP, HCAs, and Surgeons — banding nurses separately keeps that information on record while still offering everyone in the same combined Nurse dropdowns on the rota itself. This is separate from user accounts (below) — someone can be on the Staff list without having a login, and vice versa.

List types

The custom list-type values available throughout both rotas (beyond the ROUTINE/EMERGENCY/URGENT defaults).

Bank holidays

Dates marked here appear automatically on both rotas, both dashboards, and both On Call Calendars.

Copy a week's rota

Move or copy one week's saved data onto another week, for either rota — useful if a week was filled in against the wrong date by mistake. Pick any date that falls within each week; it snaps to that week's Monday automatically. Move clears the original week afterwards; Copy leaves it in place but overwrites anything already saved on the destination week.

User accounts

Create a login for a new person — name, email, a temporary password (or use Generate for a random one), and an account type (Viewer, Editor, Admin, or Board — see Section 2). Give the person their email and password directly; there's no automatic invite email.

- Change someone's account type at any time from the dropdown next to their name.
- Revoke access removes their ability to sign in to this department — it doesn't delete their underlying login entirely, but they can no longer get into this department's data.
- You can't change your own account type or revoke your own access, so there's no way to accidentally lock yourself out.

Change log

An audit trail of the most recent changes to both rotas — who made the change, when, and a preview of exactly which fields changed and what they changed from/to. Every save and publish is recorded automatically and can't be edited or deleted, so it's a genuine record for auditing purposes.

11. Your Account

Changing your password

Select the key icon next to Sign out in the sidebar to open your Account page, where you can set a new password at any time.

Dark mode and text size

Available from every screen, top-right: a moon icon toggles dark mode, and the – / + buttons step through three text sizes. Both preferences are remembered on that device.

Using Cadence on a phone

On a narrow screen, the sidebar is replaced by a menu icon (top-left) — select it to open the full navigation menu, and select outside it to close. The Theatre Board's header also adapts, stacking the hospital name, coordinator, and clock vertically instead of squeezing them side by side.

12. Installing Cadence as an App

Cadence can be installed like a normal app, with its own icon on your home screen — no app store needed.

On iPhone / iPad (Safari)

- Open Cadence in Safari.
- Select the Share icon.
- Select Add to Home Screen.

Works with no signal

Once you've opened Cadence at least once, the app itself keeps working even with no wifi or mobile signal — useful in theatre corridors. Any rota data you've already viewed stays available, and if you make a change while offline, it saves locally and syncs automatically the next time you have signal.

13. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Signs in fine, then a blank white screen	Local data on that device is stuck	Wait — after 10 seconds you'll see a Reset and try again button. This clears local data and takes you back to sign-in without losing anything.
Blank screen specifically on an iPad in Safari	Safari's "Prevent Cross-Site Tracking" blocking the live data connection	In Safari, open the page-settings ("aA") icon in the address bar → Website Settings → turn off tracking prevention for this site only.
Can't remember password	—	Use Forgot password? on the sign-in screen.
Can't see Administration	Your account is set to Viewer or Editor	Ask an Admin to change your account type, if appropriate.

14. Roles & Permissions — Full Reference

Area	Viewer	Editor	Admin	Board
Theatre Board	View	View	View	View only
Dashboards, Calendars, Staff Profiles	View	View	View	No
Either Rota	View only	Edit, save, publish	Edit, save, publish	No
Theatre Intelligence	View	View	View	No
My Week / Account settings	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Theatre Board's Team Board	Post	Post	Post	Post
Theatres, Staff, List types, Bank holidays	No	No	Manage	No
User accounts	No	No	Manage	No
Change log	No	No	View	No

Board accounts are shared logins meant to sit on a corridor kiosk purely for showing the Theatre Board — they can post to its Team Board but can't reach anything else in the app, including their own Account page, since it's a shared credential.

15. Looking Ahead

Cadence is under active development. Planned or under-consideration additions include:

- Leave and annual-leave management, alongside the existing rota and on-call data.
- Data export (CSV/PDF) for payroll or Trust audit requests.
- Push notifications for on-call cover or last-minute changes.
- Wider rollout to other departments and, longer term, other NHS Trusts.

This guide will be updated as new features are added.